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Google's AI Recommended Adding Glue To Pizza And Other Misinformation—What Caused The Viral Blunders?

By **Jack Kelly**, Former Contributor. ⓘ Jack Kelly covers career growth, job market and...

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Sundar Pichai, chief executive officer of Alphabet Inc./Photographer: David Paul Morris/Bloomberg
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Sometimes the most prominent companies make unforced errors that can harm their reputations, and be long-lasting in the minds of customers, consumers and employees. It can also serve as a hindrance in the recruitment of future talent.

There have been a number of recent controversies surrounding Google's artificial intelligence products that have provided “hallucinations”—or [misleading results](#)—for users. On social media, people shared screenshots of the search engine’s new “AI Overview” feature telling users they could use [glue to stick cheese to pizza](#) and [eat one rock per day](#).

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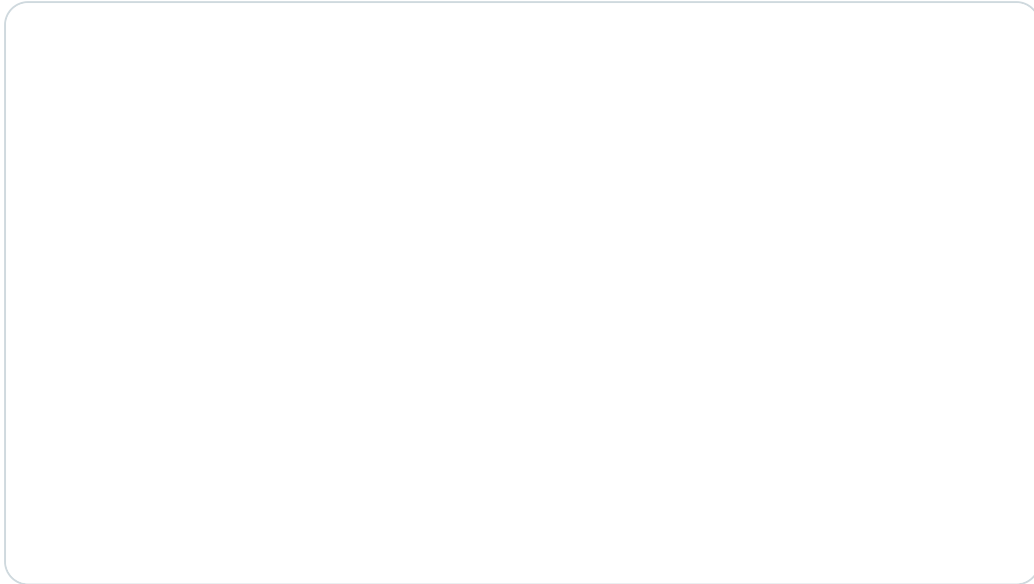
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Google AI overview suggests adding glue to get cheese to stick to pizza, and it turns out the source is an 11 year old Reddit comment from user F*cksmith 😂



11:14 AM · May 23, 2024



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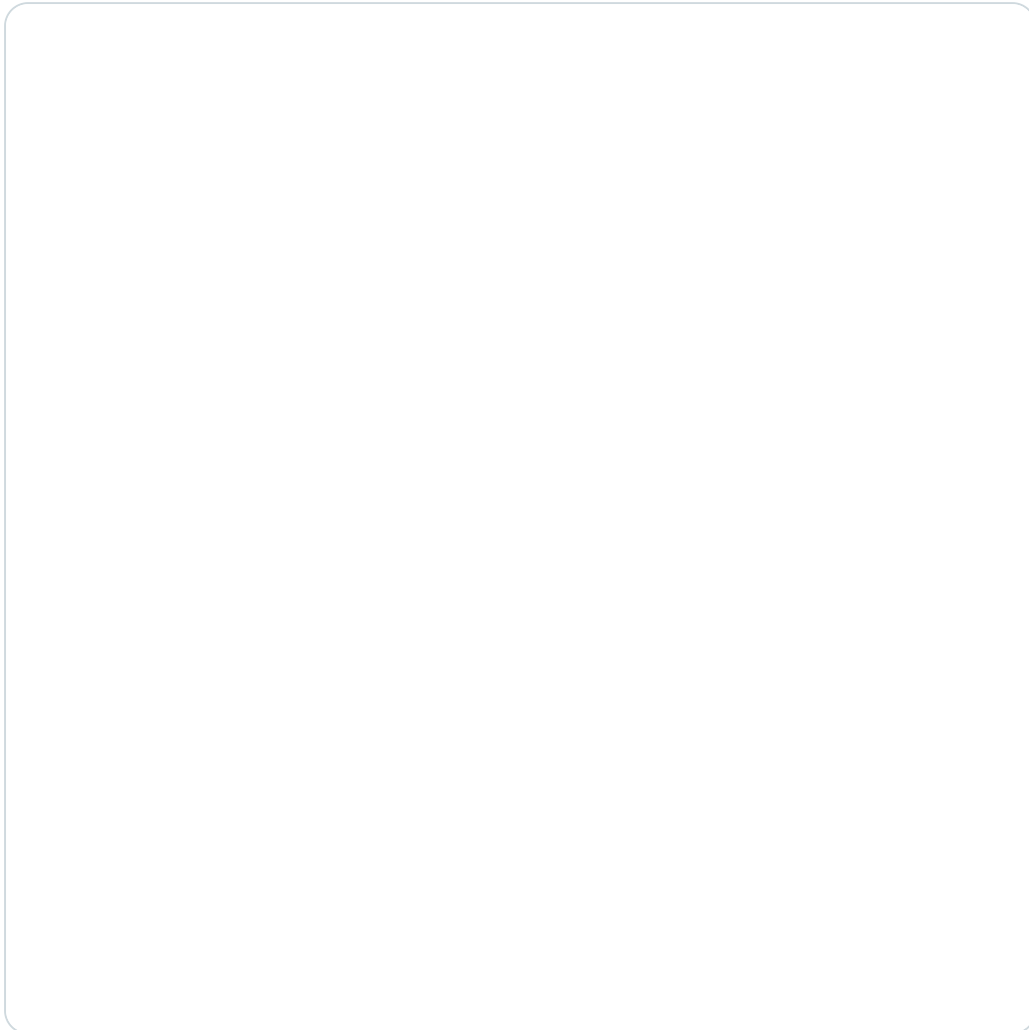
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I couldn't believe it before I tried it. Google needs to fix this asap..



7:11 AM · May 24, 2024 from Manhattan, NY



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After the AI-generated results went viral, Google reportedly scrambled to [manually remove](#) specific searches. A company spokesperson told the *Verge* that the questionable answers were appearing on “generally very uncommon queries.”

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Alphabet CEO Sundar Pichai said in a video interview with the media outlet last week that the issue of hallucinations remains an “[unsolved problem](#).”

Damage Done To Google’s Brand

The responses generated by Google’s AI Overview highlight the technology’s biases in training data, its inability to detect satire and harmful misinformation disseminated to its users conducting search queries.

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This is not the first time this year that a Google AI product rollout has come under fire due to erroneous outputs. Its Gemini image generation capability drew online fury in February for producing historically inaccurate and offensive images, such as depicting Black Vikings, as well as racially diverse Nazi soldiers and Founding Fathers of America.

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